全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 46 單元 | 性質與描述 · Quality & Description

Is This Painting Real?

這幅畫是真的嗎？

On a casual Sunday afternoon, Ya-wen and her classmate Jun-jie wandered through the narrow streets of Ximending, where a street artist had set up a small stall. Dozens of paintings leaned against the wall: some were elegant watercolors of Taipei 101 at dusk, while others showed dramatic scenes of lightning over the sea. "These are amazing," Ya-wen whispered. "Look at the detailed brushwork on this one." Jun-jie, however, was not convinced. "The colors are too consistent," he said. "I think they're fake. Printed copies, not real paintings."

The artist, an old man in baggy jeans and a dusty cap, overheard them and grinned. "A fair question," he said. "It's apparent you have good eyes, young man. Some sellers do pass off printed copies as originals. But feel this." He handed Jun-jie a delicate sheet of paper. Its surface was uneven, with small ridges where the paint had dried thickly. "Artificial prints are perfectly smooth," the artist explained. "Real watercolor leaves evidence of the brush." Jun-jie turned red; it was an awkward moment, but the artist seemed more amused than annoyed.

Then he showed them something astonishing. Taking out a brush, he painted a complete scene of the Red House in less than three minutes, his hand moving in an efficient rhythm that looked effortless. "Thirty years of practice," he said. "What looks simple is often the most complex." Ya-wen bought a small painting of a night market for her mother, and Jun-jie, now a little embarrassed but fascinated, asked whether he could watch for a while longer. "Of course," said the artist. "The essential feature of an artist is not talent. It is the willingness to keep looking."

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
casual	*adj.*	輕鬆的；隨意的	We had a casual chat over coffee. 我們邊喝咖啡邊輕鬆地聊天。
elegant	*adj.*	優雅的	She wore an elegant black dress to the party. 她穿著一件優雅的黑色洋裝去參加派對。

dramatic	*adj.*	戲劇性的；引人注目的	There was a dramatic change in the weather. 天氣出現了戲劇性的變化。
consistent	*adj.*	一致的；始終如一的	His grades have been consistent all year. 他的成績一整年都很穩定。
fake	*adj.*	假的；偽造的	The shop was caught selling fake designer bags. 這家店被抓到販賣假名牌包。
apparent	*adj.*	明顯的	It was apparent that he had not slept. 很明顯他沒有睡覺。
delicate	*adj.*	精緻的；易碎的	The delicate glass vase must be handled with care. 這個精緻的玻璃花瓶必須小心處理。
artificial	*adj.*	人造的；人工的	The restaurant decorates its tables with artificial flowers. 這家餐廳用人造花裝飾桌子。
awkward	*adj.*	尷尬的；笨拙的	There was an awkward silence after his joke. 他講完笑話後出現一陣尷尬的沉默。
astonishing	*adj.*	令人驚訝的	The young pianist gave an astonishing performance. 這位年輕鋼琴家的表演令人驚嘆。

片語 Phrases

pass off ... as	把…冒充成	He tried to pass off the copy as an original. 他試圖把複製品冒充成原作。
set up	設立；擺設	The vendors set up their stalls before six o'clock. 攤販在六點前就擺好攤位。
for a while	一會兒；一段時間	Let's sit here for a while and rest. 我們在這裡坐一會兒休息吧。

文法與句型 Grammar

It is + adj. + (that) + S + V

it 為虛主詞，真正的主詞是後面的 that 子句；用來表達「…是明顯的／重要的／可能的」等判斷。

It is apparent that you have good eyes.

很明顯你的眼力很好。

V-ing ..., S＋V（分詞構句）

當兩個子句主詞相同時，可把其中一個改成現在分詞開頭的分詞構句，表示同時發生或先後發生的動作。

Taking out a brush, he painted a complete scene in three minutes.

他拿出畫筆，三分鐘內就畫出一幅完整的景色。

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